Keynote Speaker

Professor Robert Normandeau
Université de Montréal
Montréal, Canada
robert.normandeau@umontreal.ca

Biography

After a BMus in Composition (Electroacoustics) from the Université Laval (Québec City, 1984) he moved to Montréal and completed an MMus in Composition (1988) and the first Ph.D.Mus in Electroacoustic Composition (1992), under Marcelle Deschênes and Francis Dhomont. He is a founding member of the Canadian Electroacoustic Community (CEC, 1987). From 1986 to 1993, he was an active member of the Association pour la création et la recherche électroacoustiques du Québec (ACREQ), where he produced the Clair de terre concert series at the Montréal Planetarium. In 1991, he co-founded Réseaux, an organization for the production of media arts events, notably the acousmatic concert series Rien à voir.

After a certain interest in instrumental and mixed works, his current endeavours are focused on acousmatic music. More specifically, his compositions employ esthetical criteria whereby he creates a 'cinema for the ear' in which 'meaning' as well as 'sound' become the elements that elaborate his works. Along with concert music he now writes incidental music, especially for the theatre.

Robert Normandeau is an award winner of numerous international competitions, including Ars Electronica, Linz (Austria, 1993, Golden Nica in 1996), Bourges (France, 1986, 1988, 1993), Fribourg (Switzerland, 2002), Luigi-Russolo, Varese (Italy, 1989, 1990), Métamorphoses, Bruxelles (Belgium, 2002, 2004), Musica Nova, Prague (Czech Republic, 1994, 1995, 1998), Noroit-Léonce Petitot, Arras (France, 1991, 1994), Phonurgia-Nova, Arles (France, 1988, 1987), and Stockholm (Sweden, 1992).

He is Professor in electroacoustic music composition at Université de Montréal since 1999. He received two Opus Awards from the Conseil québécois de la musique in 1999: "Composer of the Year" and "Record of the Year-Contemporary Music" for "Figures". The Académie québécoise du théâtre (AQT) has given him a Masque Award: "Best Music for Theatre" for "Malina" in 2002

He received commissions from The Banff Centre for the Arts, CKUT-FM, Codes d'Accès/Musiques et Recherches, Groupe de recherches musicales de Paris, Groupe de musique expérimentale de Marseille, Jacques Drouin, événements du neuf, Claire Marchand, Arturo Parra, Musée d'art contemporain de Montréal, Open Space Gallery, Radio-Canada, Réseaux, Sonorities Festival, Vancouver New Music and ZKM (Zentrum für Kunst und Medientechnologie). He was composer in residence at the studios of Banff (Canada, 1989, 1992, 1993), Belfast (Northern Ireland, 1997), Bourges (France, 1988, 1999, 2005), Mons (Belgium, 1996), the GRM in Paris (France, 1990, 1994), Ohain (Belgium, 1987) and ZKM (Karlsruhe, Germany, 2004)..